

Speaker1: [00:00:01] Good, so I would like to know at the beginning how you want us to refer to your partner, girlfriend, spouse, partner... Is there a particular word?

Speaker2: [00:00:13] Well, my friend, you can say my friend.

Speaker1: [00:00:16] Your friend. Very well. How long have you been with your friend?

Speaker2: [00:00:23] Uh. I've known her for [20-25] years and we've been together for almost [1-5] year.

Speaker1: [00:00:30] Okay, very well. So to start, I would simply like you to tell me a bit about the love story you are currently living with your friend.

Speaker2: [00:00:39] Well, actually, I would describe our relationship as fusionnal. Well, it has changed a bit, it has evolved a bit in the last few months because at the beginning it was really very very fusionnal. And then there are small adjustments, let's say relational and others that make us try to adapt to the situations. And as I am coming out of a separation, actually we had - we knew each other for [20-25] years - but we really, we became lovers let's say about [1-5] month after I separated from my wife actually. The separation had been planned for several months. And then I found myself immediately in this relationship which was really fusionnal from the start actually. We had known each other for a long time, but we knew each other without really knowing each other. That's it, I would say. We knew each other well, we appreciated each other well. And when we started our relationship afterward, we realized that we had a lot in common, that we had the same desires. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:02:17] You said that you knew each other without really knowing each other.

Speaker2: [00:02:22] Well yes, because actually, we talked together, we said hello, we knew each other through our children at school actually. We were in the [location] and it's been [20-25] years, about [20-25] years. And we had, we appreciated each other well, we appreciated each other well. And then when I separated from my wife actually we saw each other again, several times. And then actually we realized that we were really on the same wavelength and our relationship started like that.

Speaker1: [00:03:04] You said several times that your relationship is very fusionnal.

Speaker2: [00:03:08] Yes, actually yes, because actually we... We think the same thing. Almost the vast majority of the time we think about the same thing at the same time. Actually, when someone, when one of us is about to say something, the other is thinking about it and it happens very very often. So from this evidence, we came to say that we are, that we are... Well, that we are compatible. We want to go in the same direction actually.

Speaker1: [00:03:44] You also said that it had changed a bit. That there was an evolution in the relationship.

Speaker2: [00:03:51] Actually, I am... We are separated from my ex-wife, but the divorce is not yet pronounced so the situation remains a bit complicated. Moreover, we each have children so it was necessary... On her side, her children were quickly informed because she had been free for a very long time. On my side, it was a bit more, more delicate. So we did it by the book. We informed my children, and now, now, everything is going well. Except for the fact that I am not yet completely free, but well... Finally that I don't feel completely free because I am, but that's it. It's the administrative part that remains to be resolved. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:04:50] If I understand correctly, your friend is a person you have known for years through your children.

Speaker2: [00:04:57] Yes, that's it.

Speaker1: [00:04:57] Because you had children around the same time and so, you knew each other as parents. And you met again during your divorce. And there was an alchemy or at least something that was created.

Speaker2: [00:05:14] Yes, that's it, we can talk about alchemy. Yes, I think.

Speaker1: [00:05:16] It's a term that suits you.

Speaker2: [00:05:20] Yes. It perfectly suits the situation, I think. Yes.

Speaker1: [00:05:24] So, how did you meet? You told me about this meeting, but what happened.

Speaker2: [00:05:30] Well actually, she was my neighbor, so we talked, we saw each other from time to time. And me, when I left, as I had been in my house for [20-25] years and as I appreciate all the neighbors, actually I had... I had gone to see the neighbors explaining to them that we were separating, that I was going to leave, that we were going to leave the house and that we were going to sell the house. So I informed my neighbors and then [partner]. And as I often help my neighbors when they have little things - I am very handy and well, it's a bit my job too. I am [job] so, so [partner] had a problem with a radiator, so I came, I came to help her actually, solve her problem. Then we started talking and everything. And as she knew that I had already left actually, she offered me to have a drink and eat a pizza, as I had nothing planned for the evening well, I accepted. And then we talked, then we saw each other again and that's it. We came to the obvious of having a relationship both of us. So that's it.

Speaker1: [00:06:42] Okay. So it was in the end almost by chance.

Speaker2: [00:06:48] Yes... Well yes and no because I think that maybe before without really wanting it, there was maybe something unconsciously happening between us too, I think. I don't know, maybe. There was maybe.

Speaker1: [00:07:09] Be something.

Speaker2: [00:07:10] Let's say that we appreciated each other a lot. So I think that, that. It makes sense. I had no. I had no. No intention or anything towards her, on the contrary, I thought she was a woman who was more. Who was not necessarily made for me, but actually talking with her and then and then exchanging. Well, that's it, we came to our relationship. We came to start dating and that's it.

Speaker1: [00:07:50] You said a woman who was not necessarily made for me.

Speaker2: [00:07:54] Well actually yes, because I. I am a person who is comfortable, but I have a. I have an opinion of myself maybe that is a bit below reality I think and and so I I I underestimate myself maybe or I put myself in a case or or I put myself or I Let's say that I. I don't put myself on a pedestal. I am rather a bit more reserved so I am not. I am quite humble generally, so I that's it, I don't. I don't How to say? How could I say that? I am rather humble so. I am rather on the reserve. That's it, I will say it like that.

Speaker1: [00:08:54] So it would be something maybe more about you. Or.

Speaker2: [00:09:02] The start of our relationship, no?

Speaker1: [00:09:04] Yes also, absolutely. That interests me too, but I was talking more about the fact. You can answer me on that. I am listening if you have.

Speaker2: [00:09:12] Ah well no, but we can continue on this subject, yes.

Speaker1: [00:09:15] No, it was just. Again, what interests me is your experience. Yes. No, it's yes, indeed, it's like that. You said that you might not be good enough for her or you didn't see at the beginning? Yes, that's it. Was it more. So it's what you explained to me, it's that maybe you, you. You are sometimes very humble and that maybe in some situations, you don't put yourself forward. And so I was wondering if it was because of you that you didn't think you could be with her or is it because you also put her on a pedestal?

Speaker2: [00:09:54] More I put her, yes, more maybe on a pedestal, because for me, she is a woman who had a lot of confidence. And that's it.

Speaker1: [00:10:04] Okay. Very well. So you can also continue to. You had started talking about. Was the start of the relationship your doing or hers?

Speaker2: [00:10:15] Well I think a bit, a bit of both I think. I think that as much as I quickly felt an attraction actually I think she did too, maybe even before, maybe even before we started the relationship actually. I think.

Speaker1: [00:10:45] Hum. If you had to compare the quality of your couple's relationship with that of your friends, the couples you have with your friend currently, with those of your friends, what would you say?

Speaker2: [00:11:00] I think we are a couple. Actually, we talk about it often both of us. And when we look, yes, when we look at other couples, I think. I think we are a couple where already we are a young couple still. So it's been it's been barely a year. And I think given our age and given the love experiences we have had, I think we are a couple. Already two people who know more what they want, who will go, towards more, what they expect. And so when we compare ourselves to others, I think we are actually we give ourselves the means to succeed because we communicate, we are very much into communication already. And then. And then as I told you earlier, we are, we are really in sync, we want to do the same things, go in the same direction. So I think all this, it pushes us. Maybe to set an example to others, I think, in a way. And then we have a lot of friends who are in a couple and who have been in a couple for a very long time too. And then I think that relationships over time, love relationships, if you don't put a little spice, I think relationships diminish a bit and I think there must always be a bit of novelty in a couple for me, to to keep. To keep the flame alive as we both say with my friend. Actually, we say we will always talk to try to keep the flame and to. To always be vigilant so that our relationship remains, remains fusionnal. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:13:10] So you said set an example?

Speaker2: [00:13:14] Well maybe yes. Because I tell myself that when people see someone happy, I know I was unhappy for some time last year. And when people have already seen when I separated, I was a little better. But. But from the moment I started the relationship with my friend, people saw something change in me and told me actually. So actually, I think that setting an example is already being happy. And then I think it's like laughter, it's contagious and it can bring happiness to others. And then and then bring others also to question themselves about couple relationships I think. So that's it.

Speaker1: [00:14:03] You also talked about the fact that you need spice, to add spice.

Speaker2: [00:14:09] A little spice, yes, let's say spice more more. Yeah, maybe surprise sometimes, make surprises or or a bit of novelty I think. And to keep, yes. As if we were maintaining a fire actually, to maintain relationships and. Couple relationships.

Speaker1: [00:14:43] And do you find that some of your friends, your friends who are in a couple don't have this novelty or this spontaneity that you manage to find in your couple.

Speaker2: [00:14:54] No, I think there are people after me. I'm not someone who who settles into habits. So I think the flaw of people often is no. It's my opinion of precisely settling into habits and then actually living their life in a little routine. So some people it suits them and then others maybe not. I know that I hate taking my time. When I start taking habits of something, I try to change to to never, never fall into routine I think. Actually, I don't like falling into routine. I think that's it.

Speaker1: [00:15:41] You don't like falling into routine?

Speaker2: [00:15:44] No, no.

Speaker1: [00:15:46] Hum. In the same way, you told me about your relationship compared to that of your friends. I would like to know what you would say if you had to compare the current relationship you have with your previous relationships.

Speaker2: [00:16:01] I have never known this actually. I was well. I. I was not happy because actually I was with a person who didn't necessarily show her feelings. So. So actually, I have had very few relationships actually in my life, I have not multiplied conquests or others and I think I have never known actually what I have known for a year. And I think that during the first three months of our relationship, I almost caught up everything I did in in the [26-30] since my adolescence, in the in the past [31-35] years [31-35], having [36-40] [36-40] years, past the last [36-40] years. Hum. So actually I have never known this to this extent.

Speaker1: [00:17:10] So what is this that you are talking about? That you had not known before?

Speaker2: [00:17:14] It's. It's the fusionnal side. I have known love, I have been in love, I have been uh but but not not this not at this level. But actually it seemed immediately like like an obvious fact. And then having someone in front of you who who feels the same thing and who shows the same thing and who talks about the same thing with the same words as me actually. And that, I think it's. I think in a life it must be, I think it must be rare because she says it too. So so that's it, I think.

Speaker1: [00:18:03] What you are expressing, is in relation to your former relationships, if I understand correctly, it is a kind of natural compatibility that goes without saying, something that is not experienced.

Speaker2: [00:18:16] It's something fluid that where you don't ask yourself questions and and at the same time that is very scary. Because I had, me, in the in the past year. Actually, I had a lot of moments where it scared me a lot because I had just left actually my, my, my my wife. And. And at the beginning, I lived the the, the let's say, the first [1-5] months in total euphoria actually. And when I started to put my feet back on the ground, well actually I had a big scare actually in relation to our relationship which seemed so obvious that it scared me. Actually it. I don't know how to express it, but well, I say it like that, it's.

Speaker1: [00:19:16] At the same time, if you want to find words that seem more appropriate to your thinking, you can take the time to explain what this fear you had is.

Speaker2: [00:19:28] Then I didn't find the words, I'm not necessarily, I will not search for them too long actually. Well, I prefer to use words, words that come to me immediately, because if I start to think, I will not necessarily find them. So you do.

Speaker1: [00:19:44] What you want. Again, what interests me is your perception and your experience. In this case, can you maybe explain to me, according to you, where this fear comes from, what it was due to?

Speaker2: [00:20:00] Well, I think it's the fact of. A bit like when you discover a place that is totally unknown to you. Actually, you wonder, you can wonder, you can come to wonder I think Isn't there a wolf or if there isn't, if there isn't something hiding and that everything will collapse. Actually, the fear is more based on that. Actually, the fear of. Very quickly came the fear of losing of this relationship ending actually? And then well, there is always a relationship that persists with. With my ex actually. Which also. Well, I don't feel completely free because I am not yet completely divorced so I. My ex-wife is aware of our relationship. She also knows my friend so. But it actually puts a bit of sand in the gears actually. But But fortunately actually we talk about it between us and. And so well, there are little moments where uh, which bring, which bring doubt I think, and then we manage to talk about it, so well, it it, it resumes, it resumes its course and that's it. And then it's in my person too. I am a person sometimes who is a bit, uh, who asks himself a lot of questions and sometimes it happens to me actually when I ask myself too many questions actually to fall a bit into the hollow and to have less less morale and. And then actually my friend cheers me up and. And as we can talk about everything actually, well it also allows to find. A certain serenity and then to regain self-confidence and to start again. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:22:19] Okay. I would like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship is for you.

Speaker2: [00:22:28] A high-quality relationship I define at the romantic level, you mean Yes, yes, I would define our relationship. In this way actually, because I think that, after the fusionnal side, there is respect for the other, dialogue. And I think that I think a high-quality relationship goes through. Through things like that, through respect, dialogue, attention. That's it with these few simple words, I think, it manages to. Life of love, of course, because if there was no love, it, there would be. It would take away from the quality, I think.

Speaker1: [00:23:26] So you would say that a high-quality relationship is a respectful relationship with the other?

Speaker2: [00:23:32] Yes, I think so, yes.

Speaker1: [00:23:34] How do we know that we are in a respectful relationship with the other?

Speaker2: [00:23:39] Relationship of. We know it because I think these people, we feel it already, I think, talking with the person also. If we are, if we live a relationship in trust, in sincerity, I think it leads to being serene about the future of the couple. And then I think it, it lays the foundations, it lays the foundations and and then it allows. Well it allows to have a more. Stronger relationship. More.

Speaker1: [00:24:26] So how do we know that this relationship is stronger. It's by the results. So it's a respectful relationship since we realize afterwards that.

Speaker2: [00:24:39] The results can not. Not necessarily, it's I think it's feeling also, it's there is a part of, there is a part of feeling, of from the moment we trust and we try to hide nothing, we are honest towards the other. I think it it allows to. Yes, to. To believe in. To believe and to believe in our relationship. What of.

Speaker1: [00:25:20] So, when would you say that your relationship has been the most. A respectful relationship?

Speaker2: [00:25:32] That's it. I think really the teeth. I know all the time, all the well, all the time. There are moments where there are moments where there is always someone who takes over the other or who who. I think in every relationship, there are moments where you need to readjust. So I think there are moments where one or the other takes over because he I think, he, he wants maybe other things at the moment and it brings, it brings a reflection. So I think there are moments necessarily where where the relationship, the relationship changes a bit in relation to. In relation to the needs of each. I think sometimes we can also be led not to need the same things. So it can also bring the other to question himself and the person also who is more demanding. But everything is in the dialogue actually. I think that by exchanging it allows to readjust things and. And to maybe better know the person. There is maybe less need to readjust, there. We are in this period, I think, because after a few months, necessarily, there are differences, we have different friends, so necessarily, that, for each, it changes, it changes the life of the other actually. Because you have to, you have to know new people. Well, for now, I think we are also fusionnal on that side, because in our respective friends, actually, all our respective friends please the other. So I think that it doesn't create too many constraints for for us to move forward actually.

Speaker1: [00:27:59] Can you give me an example of moments where the relationship you have with your friend was, as you say, respectful?

Speaker2: [00:28:10] Uh, examples like that? Well, I don't really have any because generally we accept, we mutually accept each other's desires because we have the desires to see people. And when we don't feel like it either, we can each go our own way or also let each other get some fresh air a little bit to maybe breathe a bit and then recharge, recharge and allow us to start again. To come back also, more serene. Well after it's true that it also allows us to trust each other and I think after I don't really have concrete examples actually. Currently, it's something.

Speaker1: [00:29:15] That happens if I understand well, quite naturally in everyday life. Yes, you don't have concrete examples.

Speaker2: [00:29:22] No?

Speaker1: [00:29:23] So conversely, when has your relationship been the least respectful? Or respectful.

Speaker2: [00:29:35] Well, I think it's the moments when one or the other is not well actually. And well. And you have to find. You have to find a way to reassure the other. And there, I think it's in those moments that it is the least respectful, although I would not say the least respectful. Because when we care about each other and we don't want to hurt each other actually mutually. So there has always been a form of respect I think, between us actually. So I can't talk about a situation disrespectful of course.

Speaker1: [00:30:12] Sure, but also comparatively with what you described to me, that is to say this latent respect that you have, which makes the relationship always respectful. And besides you said that it was something important to you. So it is not necessarily disrespectful, but maybe there are indeed, as you said, moments where it is less so, and it's in the moments where you are both in difficulty. Actually.

Speaker2: [00:30:37] That's it, I think, yes.

Speaker1: [00:30:41] But conversely, I would like, I would like you to tell me what for you, a low-quality relationship of poor quality would be?

Speaker2: [00:30:50] Well, I think it's the relationship I lived before, a bit the relationship where there is no, where there is no. For me, the basis is communication, but it's where there is no communication, there is no, there may be love, but it is not, it is not valued by communication. I also think because I think that one does not go without the other for me and I think that a low-quality relationship is that actually, it's these lacks of communication, lack of attention, small habits that are that, that? That lead to. To no longer pay attention to the other. Actually, that's it, that's a bit what I saw, the way I lived before.

Speaker1: [00:31:51] A low-quality relationship is a relationship where there is no communication, there is no attention.

Speaker2: [00:31:57] Yes, that's it.

Speaker1: [00:32:02] Similarly, I am interested to know how we know that we are in a relationship that lacks communication. Or that lacks attention.

Speaker2: [00:32:13] How do we know? Well, you know. Well, I would say that. Well it's. It's like. It's like when it's fusionnel. It's a question of feeling. We realize actually. We realize that we are not on the same wavelength that we do not that we do not. Already if there is no communication for me, for me, everything starts from communication. Because because whether it is good, whether it is of any kind, in any form, actually, it can be communication through gestures or attention. Or talking. But the basis, I think it is oral communication. It's exchanging. Our desires, our needs, our worries, our fears. I think everything starts, everything starts from there and we know it when? Well, when we try to talk. Me from my own experience actually, when we try to talk to the person and then she has nothing to, she has nothing to say to you actually.

Speaker1: [00:33:41] Okay. And when was the relationship you are currently living the least communicative? So in this case, a relationship with less communication?

Speaker2: [00:33:53] When? When one or the other is not well, actually there is less communication. That's the result. That's it, that's it.

Speaker1: [00:34:03] Is it because there is less communication that it is not going well? Or is it because it is not going well that there is less communication?



Speaker2: [00:34:13] But I think it is a question of, of inner well-being. Already it can be related to external problems, to the couple also, it can be related to problems, for example at work, money problems, problems of. Problems of relationships with others. Or conflicts or. It can be friends too, it can be people who are who, who are harmful to us. Relationships that we can have each on our side, which do not suit the other. For me, it can be things like that, which. Which lead to. To this result actually.

Speaker1: [00:35:12] Okay. So if I understand well, what you told me, it is really the moments where the things you qualify as low quality in a relationship, are things that are corollaries actually, to the fact of feeling bad at a moment. And which happen in reaction to that. Yes.

Speaker2: [00:35:37] Very well. Or external facts I think it's often external facts.

Speaker1: [00:35:44] It's not related to the relationship itself. These are external things that come not necessarily.

Speaker2: [00:35:49] Afterwards, it can be related to the relationship between the two beings also who are not, who may not be compatible. Everyone, everyone is not compatible. We can fall in love young with someone and then realize actually that it is not necessarily the right person.

Speaker1: [00:36:12] Very well. I would also like you to tell me the things that are the most important to you in a romantic relationship. We talked about a few, but there may be others.

Speaker2: [00:36:22] A romantic relationship, I think it's the attention above all, it is being attentive, being attentive in the sense, uh, being observant too, knowing what the other wants, what the other needs and and the. And try to surprise them with attention, gestures, those. That's it, for me it's. It's one of the most important things. And then the one I told you earlier, communication, the.

Speaker1: [00:37:07] But tell me, tell me, I'm listening.

Speaker2: [00:37:09] No, no, I don't have anything special. Go ahead!

Speaker1: [00:37:12] No, no, please. Again, it's. It's your feeling that interests me. So don't hesitate to.

Speaker2: [00:37:18] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:37:19] Say everything that comes to mind.

Speaker2: [00:37:23] That's it. No, that's all I think. It's mostly communication and attention actually. The attention we and the importance we give to the other person also, I think. Yes, also.

Speaker1: [00:37:35] You mentioned the fact of surprising the other.

Speaker2: [00:37:40] Well yes, because actually, I think that's what also allows to maintain, to maintain this spark. Actually, it's to sometimes surprise, to do yes, to do surprises even if they are very simple, a little attention or. Or please them with something they mentioned at some point, and we remembered and put aside to please them. And I think that maintains the. It maintains the spark actually, and.

Speaker1: [00:38:28] It maintains the spark.

Speaker2: [00:38:30] Yes, it's very important, that for us in our relationship, we have always since the beginning, we have told ourselves that actually we need to. Because actually we have known slightly difficult relationships and. And so I think it's from the start, actually, we told ourselves that we needed to set the foundations and that we, we imposed on ourselves to tell each other things and to always try to surprise each other actually. And we find it very important actually.

Speaker1: [00:39:09] This notion of maintaining the spark, keeping. I understand well the freshness, the enthusiasm of the encounter.

Speaker2: [00:39:18] Yes, exactly.

Speaker1: [00:39:20] Is that what you mean?

Speaker2: [00:39:21] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:39:23] I would like you to tell me, based on your experiences, what love is for you.

Speaker2: [00:39:33] Yeah well I don't know. I would say that love is a. True love for me is a feeling. It's something that is going to be felt. That is going to be felt at some point in. In the relationship, it will start. Yes, for me it will start from the fusion of two people actually from their. From their feelings each actually. And that it is. After, it may not be a shared feeling. Sometimes too, we can be in love with someone without, without the person even being aware. Being informed. But I think it's a feeling, it's I think it's it's an attraction. It's, it's more. I would describe it as, I would describe love as an attraction, I think.

Speaker1: [00:40:50] Love is an attraction for you.

Speaker2: [00:40:54] We are attracted to a person, to something. After it may not necessarily be related to a person, it can be related to. It's that I don't know, it's that we see. We see, we feel things towards a person or or maybe like like towards an animal. There are people, they are. It's like love I think, who love for example cats or. And I think that love especially towards a person is yeah, it's I think it's it's an attraction, it's that we. It's difficult. It's difficult to express.

Speaker1: [00:41:55] Do it with your words. You can take the time if you want.

Speaker2: [00:41:58] For me, it is a feeling, so it is something totally invisible, elusive, and it is not necessarily shared. But when it is shared, it is even stronger. That's the sublime.

Speaker1: [00:42:16] You said it, you said it twice I think, or even three times that love is not always shared. No.

Speaker2: [00:42:23] No, I think there are people who can be in love with a person and without without the person being of the same. Being in love too actually. I think.

Speaker1: [00:42:38] You would say that for you, it has what importance in a relationship?

Speaker3: [00:42:41] Who.

Speaker2: [00:42:47] It has all its importance. Because if If we don't feel this feeling, the relationship already has less. It already has less importance. Actually, it's, I think it's completely linked to the mind or the feelings of each person. But there are surely also people who are more or less in love with a person. I think.

Speaker1: [00:43:19] For you, it has all its importance as you say. So a central, major importance, something that is important for you, in any case in a relationship. We know that there are different forms and ways of loving. I would like you to tell me how you know that your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:43:46] Well I feel it because we say it all the time, we have trouble being apart, we want to be together all the time. So I think that. It's feeling, it's feeling. And at the same time, when we want to be together all the time, it means what it means I think and it is it is the most telling.

Speaker1: [00:44:16] For you, it is the time spent together.

Speaker2: [00:44:19] Yes, that contributes a lot. Yes yes.

Speaker1: [00:44:23] It's the fact that she takes her time to spend it with you that makes you feel loved or that makes you.

Speaker2: [00:44:30] Know that there is. What I was talking about earlier too, there are attentions. We pay attention to the other, to give them what they want. But in addition I see. For us, the fact that for example we think the same thing at the same time, well that also develops this feeling actually, because we say we are going in the same direction and therefore that makes it even stronger, I think, that sublimates it.

Speaker1: [00:45:06] A form of connection.

Speaker2: [00:45:07] Yes, that's it, yes, it's a bit like that, yes, it's like neurons. We are connected together and.

Speaker1: [00:45:18] That sublimates the relationship.

Speaker2: [00:45:22] That sublimates the feeling, yeah, the feeling of love. Yeah, I think. Okay.

Speaker1: [00:45:30] I would like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with your friend.

Speaker2: [00:45:40] Well. Earlier, just before we were just before she left actually. And in addition, the positive is rather let's say. To say also well here, I don't know. It can be simple things. Asking if her day went well, things like that, that. Very simple things or or a kiss or. That's it.

Speaker1: [00:46:19] So, what was this positive interaction you had just before? What happened?

Speaker2: [00:46:24] When we met again? Because, actually, I was at my place last night, we were not together. So when we met again earlier coming back, that's it, it's nothing but that. A positive interaction for me is is to meet again actually to be together.

Speaker1: [00:46:43] Can you similarly tell me about one of the last negative interactions you had with your friend?

Speaker2: [00:46:52] When we make remarks. Actually, when we cook or things on which we have the same point of view, but we do them differently actually. And that, that can be a slightly negative interaction I would say, But as we say things, well that's it, actually we come to the same, the same results. So that's it.

Speaker1: [00:47:16] Can you give me an example, for example.

Speaker2: [00:47:21] Well well actually when when she cooks, she always tends to put the gas high. And then I go behind and lower it and so she. Well, it's not really negative because actually in itself, that's it, it makes us laugh more than anything. It's little things like that. But there aren't really any actually. So I'm trying to find, but there aren't really any.

Speaker1: [00:47:57] I would like you to tell me, in your opinion, the challenges to overcome in your relationship.

Speaker2: [00:48:05] Challenges to overcome. Actually, I think it's challenges we impose on ourselves to please the other. I think it's more that for me, it would be more in that sense. For a while, I had been so, so impressed by the strength of our relationship that that that I underestimated myself. And actually, the challenge to overcome for me was to do everything to seduce her. And that's it. And then. And also to accept, to accept our differences. It's a little challenge too to overcome, but it comes so naturally that actually, it's the same. It's not really. It's not really a challenge. It's more a challenge of my person which was harder to overcome. But now it's me. We reassure each other on us actually? Because actually, when as I was talking about earlier, when we are not well actually, well we reassure each other too because we can think that it is our fault when someone is not well, we will, we will think it's our fault while actually, we reassure ourselves on that side. It's when? When? I'm not well, I tell her it has

nothing to do with you. Actually. It's me who I I think too much and and I scare myself. And she, she thought it could come from her actually. Hum. Cool. And the challenges are maybe to manage to reassure each other, then to find the right words too. The words that suit to say things to each other. That's important to me too because I don't always manage to find the words to express myself and so I try that. It's really a challenge for me to find sometimes. It's good. For now I think I'm doing not too bad.

Speaker1: [00:50:28] So the right words for the right thought, that's what you mean? To express well what you feel, that's what matches what you were telling me earlier about communication which is very important to you and that if I understood well by the way, you didn't have or less in your previous relationship.

Speaker3: [00:50:48] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:50:50] That's by the way what makes. It's one of the reasons, if I understood well, that makes this current relationship with your friend suit you so well and work well.

Speaker3: [00:51:01] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:51:04] Hum. Well, we know that sometimes in a relationship, everything is not rosy. And I would like you to talk about the conflicts or disputes you can have with your partner.

Speaker2: [00:51:15] Actually, we haven't had too many. The conflicts, it would be more. Maybe more to external sources or at the beginning. Me I. As I didn't want more animals all that and maybe the conflicts would be more. But well, now it's no longer the case, but it would be more related to the little habits of each that we have to let things be or the habits we have related to yes, for example related to animals, things like that, me I in a house, I like cleanliness, all that and there are for example animals, cats that climb on furniture or things like that. I have more trouble with that. But again, me I see, now I tell myself we are together, we live together. So I I I accept things and I tell her. And then she tells me actually that she doesn't like that either. So that's it. But well, the animals we can't prevent. That's it, it would be more little things like that I would say, related to the little habits of each or sometimes there is always when when we want to look for flaws or something in a person, we can always find. Nobody is perfect, so we can always find things that could bother. But I think that when a relationship is fusionnel and we want to move forward, it poses fewer problems I think. We overlook certain things, but still we can. I manage, but there may be people who manage, me who do that.

Speaker1: [00:53:13] And these little conflicts as you call them, these little everyday conflicts. What would be their frequency?

Speaker3: [00:53:20] For you.

Speaker1: [00:53:22] So in the last fifteen days for example.

Speaker2: [00:53:25] I don't know, maybe once or twice, once or twice.

Speaker1: [00:53:31] And how then do you resolve them, these conflicts you talked about? What do you do to resolve them?

Speaker2: [00:53:38] Well actually, I think from experience, I think we need to express what we feel to the person actually. But it's the same, we need to find the words. That's it, I think we just need to express what we feel, no taboos, because for me things left unsaid, it, it accumulates and it festers. And for me, it only leads to negative. So I think it's better to say things once if really I think we agree on that actually, we say things to each other. So if there is something that's not right, we try to say it quickly.

Speaker1: [00:54:26] Through communication then. Actually yes, it's communication that allows to resolve.

Speaker2: [00:54:30] Yes I think it's communication.

Speaker1: [00:54:33] Yes okay.

Speaker2: [00:54:34] Taking it on yourself, I think it doesn't necessarily bring positive.

Speaker1: [00:54:43] Besides communication, what are the other ways through which you maintain your relationship?

Speaker2: [00:54:57] The attention, as I was saying earlier, the attention we give to the other and. The surprises? Surprising the other? I think it's. For me it's it's the basis to be attentive also to the little moments when she has doubts or. And then trying to detect those moments of, of, of. The fact of talking, already, it allows to know each other better and to apprehend and then the fact that we are a bit fusionnel, we can guess, guess in the other what is happening actually. Before they even have to tell us I think. After she, she is more gifted than me for that. I am. I am less. I lived a long time with someone with whom I exchanged very little about our relationship. And now I am in the renewal. So I am relaunching myself, it's sure, in communication, but I think that now. I am convinced that communication is the basis of relationships actually, And I think it's, it's, it's important.

Speaker1: [00:56:20] Okay. I would like to know what could make you leave your partner.

Speaker2: [00:56:28] Well I think the first thing would be still that that that I be cheated on actually. That I be cheated on. That she hides things from me and that I discover them. Actually, it's. I think that would make me. That would make me radically make a decision.

Speaker1: [00:56:57] Uh. Why? And why would that make you?

Speaker2: [00:57:03] Why? Because if we if we maintain a relationship of trust, for me, we must. Tell each other everything. Well. But I think at the age, at the age I am well, I would be [26-30]. Maybe it would be different. But now I am. I think I would ask myself fewer questions and it would make me. That's it, it would make me less afraid to leave the ship immediately I think.

Speaker1: [00:57:38] You also said we must tell each other everything. You think we must tell each other everything in a relationship?

Speaker2: [00:57:47] Well, we can talk about. Yes, there are things sometimes that we don't dare to say either to not worry the other. Or maybe to keep the peace sometimes. And then I know that I manage to not say things and then forget them afterwards. And then it depends on the importance of things I think. For me, important things, we must absolutely say them.

Speaker1: [00:58:27] Important things, you say? Important things, we must absolutely say them.

Speaker3: [00:58:32] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:58:35] What? When you tell me important things?

Speaker2: [00:58:39] Well, actually, the things that can help better understand the person, the things that, the important things that happened in the past, that concern them directly. After, there are things about other people, of course, that we can't say, that we know about other people and that we can't necessarily always say. But. Everything that actually helps to lay, to build the foundations of the couple. Actually, everything that is important to say, I think it should be said.

Speaker3: [00:59:19] From the beginning.

Speaker2: [00:59:21] And then. And then also, if there are things, there might be things we hide at the beginning, then that we can say. But as far as I know, there is nothing I haven't told her, that's it. I think she has too. But we are. We can never be sure actually. Because actually, we live with other people, but we only know what we have inside us, we don't know what is inside others. And I think the important things should be said.

Speaker1: [00:59:59] Would you say that this relationship you are currently living is good for you?

Speaker3: [01:00:05] Yes, yes.

Speaker2: [01:00:07] It only brings me good things.

Speaker1: [01:00:13] Tell me more.

Speaker2: [01:00:16] Well. For me. Actually, it's an obvious fact. So I. Even if at the beginning the first months it's really we are on a cloud and all. Now, the fact of taking. Taking a bit of a step back on our relationship. It allows me to really believe in it. That's it.

Speaker3: [01:00:54] That's said. It only brings me good things, good things.

Speaker2: [01:01:01] Happiness, actually. That's it, happiness, sharing too. And then how to say. It reassures me actually. It. It allows me to move forward too. It. It pushes me. It lifts me up. Actually, I think that's what it is. Me I hoped for that, so I didn't expect it actually. That's it, [11-

15] days before really meeting this person, even if I knew her before, meeting her in another way, I had told my daughter, well I had told my daughter who was still [21-25] years old Dad, she will find herself, I will, I will stay alone for a long time actually. Because I was vaccinated actually. And actually no. So that's it.

Speaker3: [01:02:06] If I.

Speaker1: [01:02:06] Understand well, she helps you actually to achieve your goals, to become the person that.

Speaker3: [01:02:14] You see that I think.

Speaker2: [01:02:14] Lifting me up. Well, we motivate each other too, we motivate, we support each other, we.

Speaker3: [01:02:26] And then we.

Speaker2: [01:02:30] All while respecting the other. Actually, we can, we can lift them up.

Speaker1: [01:02:36] You also mentioned earlier in the interview that she helped you too to some extent, to regulate your daily functioning when sometimes you could have more difficult moments.

Speaker2: [01:02:53] More difficult moments. Yes, she allows me to. She carries me actually. When like I do when? When she is not well too, even if it is quite rare but or she doesn't show it. But but when I see that she is not well, I also try to reassure her.

Speaker1: [01:03:18] Is what you were saying earlier about being attentive to the other? I would like to know if you think you are the same person as before your current relationship.

Speaker3: [01:03:30] Otherwise, no.

Speaker1: [01:03:34] More.

Speaker3: [01:03:37] I am.

Speaker2: [01:03:37] More jovial. Yes. At times I, at times, I was a bit depressed. I didn't. Besides, I went through a big period of depression before making the decision of my separation and. I think.

Speaker3: [01:04:02] That.

Speaker2: [01:04:06] That, I am completely different. Actually, I am more. But people told me too as soon as I met her, even if I had not told anyone, people had seen something changed in me in my behavior. Actually, I was more. I was more jovial, but not only that. I was more dynamic too I think. It re-energized me actually. And actually I know the fact, I think just



believing in life and that life brings you. Already I am like that naturally. I think that life can bring us beautiful things and.

Speaker3: [01:04:51] And.

Speaker2: [01:04:52] And that's it, it brought me that, I think. Actually, it it lifted me up and then and then changed my behavior in a good way. And then being good with others too, because it's each one of our qualities I think. We. The kind helpers. That's it.

Speaker1: [01:05:14] And concerning your friend, do you think she has changed during and compared to before the relationship?

Speaker2: [01:05:24] I think yes, because people saw it too in her, so they saw the same thing as in me I think in her circle, her family and and her children actually. And yes, I think they saw another person.

Speaker3: [01:05:37] Because.

Speaker2: [01:05:37] Because she lived alone for a long time. And she had relationships too before. But that and that didn't suit her I think. And that's it. After me I I. Actually, we are not in judgment of each other about what we did before or the people we were with. So actually when we are together, we only think about us and and then, and then people, I think that yes, people around her saw it too because we talk about it with people too, we talk about it with others, between us, we don't necessarily talk about it separately, and then people tell us. I have a lot of friends who told me in front of her. In front of her that that that I was different. I was someone else.

Speaker1: [01:06:35] And she has changed similarly to you, in the same trajectory, on the same things. Because it is.

Speaker2: [01:06:45] Well I think yes, I think it's I. From what she told me, yes because people were super happy for her and I think, I think it happened in about the same way as me with my circle actually. People were very positive about. About her, about her new relationship. So.

Speaker1: [01:07:16] Because the relationship you are currently living with your friend, with [partner], is a relationship where you feel safe.

Speaker3: [01:07:26] Yes. Yes. Yes.

Speaker2: [01:07:29] Yes, because I feel. I know I can count on her and vice versa, I think. I think that. She must. Must feel it too. I hope. But normally yes, according to what she tells me.

Speaker1: [01:07:47] It's a relationship where you can, for example, open up to her about your experiences, your thoughts, your identity, without fearing judgment or repercussions.

Speaker3: [01:08:00] Completely, yes.

Speaker2: [01:08:02] Yes, for me, it's an obvious fact. That's it.

Speaker1: [01:08:07] You can be yourself.

Speaker3: [01:08:08] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:08:11] It's also a relationship where, for example, you can get comfort or attention from your partner when you are. You feel in distress or in danger?

Speaker3: [01:08:23] Yes.

Speaker2: [01:08:25] That's what happens actually. Yes, it's It's completely what happens.

Speaker3: [01:08:29] Compared to.

Speaker1: [01:08:30] What you told me earlier. Sometimes you have lower moments than others and she is there for you.

Speaker3: [01:08:38] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:08:42] Well. I would now like to briefly address another dimension that is constitutive of couple relationships, which is sexuality. We know that it can or cannot be a more or less important dimension for people in a relationship. Is it for you?

Speaker2: [01:08:58] Well yes, actually, it's a. It's a continuation of our relationship, I would say, it's. Actually, it's the culmination of, of, of our relationship, of our exchanges. Yeah, I think it's actually, it's completely, completely linked to. To our conversations. And it's not a taboo subject. So. Yeah, I think it's it's more a continuation of our relationship, I would say. For me, one does not go without the other. We are both on this wavelength actually that I. I think both. I think we can't have sexual relations just to have sexual relations. It's for. For me, it's a whole. I am not.

Speaker1: [01:10:05] Meaning if it is a continuation. One does not go without the other, does that mean it is constitutive of a relationship then for you?

Speaker2: [01:10:13] Yes, it is consecutive, yes, constitutive. Meaning?

Speaker1: [01:10:24] Meaning it is inherent to a relationship. You see? Do you see, for example, having a romantic relationship with someone in which there is no sexuality?

Speaker2: [01:10:36] Well, I think it could be possible because for me it's not necessarily for me, it's not necessarily a goal. So we we we do, but not all the time. And it's not necessarily, it's not. I don't necessarily need that to. To. To have a romantic relationship with her? If. If anything happened that prevented us? Well, it wouldn't change much actually. That's it.

Speaker1: [01:11:20] Okay. Can you tell me really, roughly, talk to me about the frequency of your sexual relations? About.

Speaker2: [01:11:29] Well, it depends, sometimes. Sometimes often, sometimes not, I would say. Three, four times a week.

Speaker1: [01:11:40] Are you satisfied? Sorry?

Speaker3: [01:11:42] I'm listening. Yes, he.

Speaker2: [01:11:43] Sometimes it's more, sometimes it's less.

Speaker1: [01:11:48] Are you satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker3: [01:11:51] Loïc has it in mind. But.

Speaker1: [01:11:57] I also wanted to know. At the very beginning, we talked about your previous relationships. Can you tell me how many relationships you had before this one?

Speaker2: [01:12:08] Uh well actually, it's the third, the fourth.

Speaker3: [01:12:13] The fourth, the fourth.

Speaker1: [01:12:17] So I am going to show you a scale and I am going to ask you to answer two questions. It's very short. According to this scale, I will share it with you right away. So. Can you see it well?

Speaker3: [01:12:32] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:12:33] So, in general, my partner really listens to me, it goes from 1 to 9. Not at all true and nine completely true. What would you say?

Speaker2: [01:12:44] I would put eight.

Speaker1: [01:12:45] You would put eight? Yes. So why eight?

Speaker3: [01:12:49] How? Why?

Speaker1: [01:12:50] Eight.

Speaker2: [01:12:53] Well, I would tend to put nine, but as she is very talkative, sometimes she doesn't listen to me. Sometimes she talks more than she listens. So it's more for the fun side.

Speaker1: [01:13:07] So why not seven? So why eight and not seven?

Speaker2: [01:13:14] Because. Because for important things, she listens to me all the time, for things. When things are not going well, she listens to me. But I would tend to put nine when she really listens to me.

Speaker3: [01:13:30] That's it.

Speaker1: [01:13:32] So my partner is generally attentive to my needs.

Speaker2: [01:13:38] Yes, she even anticipates them so. Yes, I would put nine and nine.

Speaker3: [01:13:46] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:13:47] So why not eight?

Speaker2: [01:13:52] Because. Actually, when, When? When I ask her something. She, she, she, she agrees right away. She lets me do what I want actually. After, our relationship is recent too, but. But I think that's it, she is someone who is very who is very attentive and. Who? Who? Who is very attentive to my needs I think.

Speaker1: [01:14:29] So how satisfied are you with your relationship? Completely dissatisfied. Very dissatisfied. Rather dissatisfied. Uncertain. Neutral. Rather satisfied. Very satisfied or completely satisfied.

Speaker2: [01:14:41] I would put completely satisfied.

Speaker1: [01:14:43] You would be completely satisfied?

Speaker3: [01:14:45] Yes.

Speaker2: [01:14:47] I would put very satisfied. I would put very.

Speaker3: [01:14:50] Satisfied. It's up to you. Yes.

Speaker1: [01:14:54] Well, if we switch. You answered me in verbal form, now in numerical form. If Zero was not at all satisfied and ten completely satisfied, what number would you give to evaluate the degree of satisfaction you have with your relationship?

Speaker2: [01:15:12] I would put nine.

Speaker1: [01:15:16] So why nine and not eight or ten?

Speaker2: [01:15:21] Well because. You can always. I would tend to put ten. It's that when I have a questionnaire like this, I never, I never put the extreme scores actually. But yeah, I. Completely satisfied. Actually, it's more in relation to the fact that our relationship is very recent and.

Speaker3: [01:15:53] Yeah.

Speaker2: [01:15:54] I think it's more in relation to that, that we still. We still surely have things to learn from each other and. I think for that, I would put nine.

Speaker1: [01:16:08] Very well. So we are approaching the end of the interview.

Speaker3: [01:16:17] Yes.

Speaker1: [01:16:19] I will simply summarize what you said. And then you correct me if there are things I misunderstood, or you can also add things to clarify, don't hesitate. So, you told me about your friend that you have known for a long time as a neighbor and as a fellow parent. You already had interactions with her? And when you separated from your wife. In any case, it was finalized, even if it is not yet administratively finalized. But when it started, you found yourself meeting her quite by chance in the end, because if I understood correctly, it's a story about a radiator. And from there began a quite natural relationship. You said it was really a kind of alchemy, something quite organic. You talked about the fact that compared to your friends, you found that there is in your relationship a spontaneity and spice, something that makes it, that there is renewal actually and that there is. You did not use this term, but maybe no routine. I don't know if it's a term you would use.

Speaker2: [01:17:34] Yes, no routine. Yes, I think, yes, yes.

Speaker1: [01:17:38] And compared to your past relationships, it's the communication above all that is different. The fact that in this relationship, there is much more communication on both sides and that since it is on both sides, it almost creates a movement. At the couple level. As for the quality relationship, you talked to me about several things, you talked to me about communication, respect. Uh. Conversely, you talked to me about a relationship that was not communicative in the low quality. It was something that was problematic for you. The things that were important to you in a romantic relationship were spontaneity, attention and not just attention to the other. It's being attentive to the other. Attentive to their moments of weakness, for example. It is something you have. On which you have insisted a lot. Hum. We also talked about love. And the place it has in a couple. Quite an important place for you. And that the way you know that your partner loves you is through attention. It is through attention and it is something. You said it at several moments, it is something we feel.

Speaker1: [01:19:06] We feel when it goes well, just like when it doesn't go well. You also talked about the positive or negative interactions you could have. The positive interactions are very simple interactions since you told me it's the simple fact of seeing her. And the negative interactions. You gave me the example. You actually gave me two examples. The example of the animals. And the example of the fire, little interactions like that. The challenges you had to overcome in your relationship, but especially given the example in relation to you. That is to say, you had to communicate better. At the beginning, it was something that was not obvious to you. And also not or rather feel up to it and almost in a sense legitimate compared to this woman and. That you now, I have the impression, according to what you said, managed to do that. Which makes. All the more happy. You told me that you had very few conflicts and that the conflicts, really that you had, were very trivial things.

Speaker3: [01:20:23] That's it.

Speaker1: [01:20:26] And that the means you had to maintain the relationship are means. Again, of spontaneity. Actually, something, we want to do it, we keep it, we keep it. You talked

about spice at the beginning, it is also something that fit into the discussion we had at that moment. The things that were unacceptable for you, it was being cheated on and more generally, actually breaking the trust. Not telling each other things. And finally, you told me that indeed, you thought that you and your friend, this relationship, you have changed for the better. That it helped both of you and you were both happier and more radiant visibly, since your friends tell you. Hum, that's it. Is there anything you would like to add or modify about what I said? Something that is important to you?

Speaker3: [01:21:33] No, I think.

Speaker2: [01:21:34] I think we covered about everything. After, me, it's a relationship more that stays in simplicity, respect and that's it, it's. We both like simple things and we don't overthink.

Speaker1: [01:21:57] Is what you are telling me that the relationship is in simplicity because it is done in simplicity?

Speaker3: [01:22:02] Yes, because.

Speaker2: [01:22:03] It's fluid actually, because that's it, it seems simple actually.

Speaker1: [01:22:10] Earlier, we discussed, you know, what a quality relationship was, a high quality relationship. Would you say that, for example, a quality relationship is a relationship that is simple, that is in simplicity, because there may be a nuance.

Speaker2: [01:22:23] Well yes, I think that when things are fluid, everything becomes simple and accessible. So I think that's.

Speaker3: [01:22:37] It's.

Speaker2: [01:22:38] Relationships. That's something that leads to simplicity actually. I think we ask ourselves fewer questions, we ask ourselves fewer existential questions about what we should do or.

Speaker1: [01:22:57] So before finishing, I don't know if you read it in the in the free consent form, there is also normally a second form called Data Notice. Basically, we have two ways to handle the data, either we keep only parts of the transcript, or we keep the whole interview. The interest for us of one or the other is to later be able to work on the speeches to make analyses and then eventually other researchers can verify what we found or reuse the data set for other research. We leave the choice to people from an ethical point of view, but both in any case are anonymized, whether it is entire parts or only selected parts. Do you have a preference or.

Speaker2: [01:23:53] Well I don't know what you are. [partner] compared to.

Speaker1: [01:23:57] [partner] told me she didn't care, that it was what suited us as researchers the most.

Speaker2: [01:24:05] Yes well, I will do the same. I don't mind at all, I am not very.

Speaker1: [01:24:10] Well in that case, it will be again everything is anonymized and.

Speaker2: [01:24:14] Anonymous. That's it.

Speaker1: [01:24:16] Everything is anonymized. It's only the principle, because as the study is conducted in different countries, I don't know if you know that and so we harmonize everything and in some countries etc. Okay. So just one last thing. Actually, I have two little things to ask you. First, I will ask you if you can fill out a very short questionnaire that should not really take more than five minutes that I am putting right away in the link in the discussion. I will turn off the camera and the microphone, but if you need me, I am here, so don't hesitate.

Speaker2: [01:24:55] Do I need to send it back to you or no? It's online directly.

Speaker1: [01:24:57] Yes, it's online, no worries.

Speaker3: [01:25:00] Okay. Thank you. But.